

Esau's wives

Some Bible footnotes & study material might assert that one of Esau's wives ([Genesis 28:9](#)) named "Mahalath" is the same woman as the "Bashemath" in one or both of [Genesis 26:34](#) & [Genesis 36:3](#). Is there any Biblical evidence to support that?

Genesis 28:8-9

⁸ And Esau seeing that the daughters of Canaan pleased not Isaac his father;

⁹ Then went Esau unto Ishmael, and took unto the wives which he had Mahalath^{H4258} the daughter of Ishmael Abraham's son, the sister of Nebajoth, to be his wife.

- Ishmael is a descendant of Shem the son of Noah.

Genesis 26:34

And Esau was forty years old when he took to wife Judith^{H3067} the daughter of Beeri the Hittite, and Bashemath^{H1315} the daughter of Elon the Hittite:

- Hittites (the sons of Heth) are descendants of Canaan son of Ham the son of Noah.

Genesis 36:2-3

² Esau took his wives of the daughters of Canaan; Adah^{H5711} the daughter of Elon the Hittite, and Aholibamah^{H173} the daughter of Anah the daughter of Zibeon the Hivite;

³ And Bashemath^{H1315} Ishmael's daughter, sister of Nebajoth.

H4258 & H1314 are both entirely different, unrelated, Hebrew words so there's no connection there. Relying on [Genesis 28:9](#)'s use of the definite article "the" before "sister of Nebajoth" is simply not rightly dividing the word of truth:

Mark 12:35

And Jesus answered and said, while he taught in the temple, **How say the scribes that Christ is the Son of David?**

Revelation 22:16

I Jesus have sent mine angel to testify unto you these things in the churches. I am the root and the offspring of David, and the bright and morning star.

1 Chronicles 3:1-9

1 Now these were the sons of David, which were born unto him in Hebron; the firstborn Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; the second Daniel, of Abigail the Carmelitess: 2 The third, Absalom the son of Maachah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur: the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith: 3 The fifth, Shephatiah of Abital: the sixth, Ithream by Eglah his wife. 4 These six were born unto him in Hebron; and there he reigned seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty and three years. 5 And these were born unto him in Jerusalem; Shimea, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, four, of Bathshua the daughter of Ammiel: 6 Ibhar also, and Elishama, and Eliphelet, 7 And Nogah, and Nepheg, and Japhia, 8 And Elishama, and Eliada, and Eliphelet, nine. 9 These were all the sons of David, beside the sons of the concubines, and Tamar their sister.

- There are many such examples as these all throughout Scripture that tell us undoubtedly that when the definite article "the" is used to denote a child God does not necessarily mean it was the only child.
- God is not the author of confusion so he didn't leave us to guess what He means: He is explicit when it is necessary and we should be rightly cautious to jump to conclusions without evidence ([1Thess. 5:21](#)). The workers of iniquity have no such qualms about perverting the truth.

Gen 26:34	• Judith ^{H3067} (daughter of Beerli the Hittite)	• Noah → Ham → Canaan → Heth → (Hittites) (Genesis 10:6-15, 23:10, 49:32)
	• Bashemath ^{H1315} (daughter of Elon the Hittite)	
Gen 28:8,9	• Mahalath ^{H4258} (daughter of Ishmael, sister of Nebajoth)	• Noah → Shem → Abraham & Hagar → Ishmael → Nebajoth/Nebaioth (Genesis 25:12,13)
Gen 36:2-4	• Adah ^{H5711} (daughter of Elon the Hittite)	• Noah → Ham → Canaan → Heth → (Hittites)
	• Aholibamah ^{H173} (daughter of Anah ^{H6034} the daughter of Zibeon ^{H6649} the Hivite)	• Noah → Ham → Canaan → Hivite (Genesis 10:15-17, 1Ch 1:15)
	• Bashemath ^{H1315} (daughter of Ishmael, sister of Nebajoth)	• Noah → Shem → Abraham → Ishmael (Genesis 10:1, 11:10-26, 25:12,13)

And so just looking at Scripture the list of Esau's wives is very simply laid out for us:

- Noah → Ham → Canaan
 - Judith daughter of Beerli (Hittite)
 - Bashemath daughter of Elon (Hittite)
 - Adah daughter of Elon (Hittite)
 - Aholibamah daughter of Zibeon (Hivite)
- Noah → Shem → Abraham → Ishmael
 - Mahalath daughter of Ishmael (Ishmaelite)
 - Bashemath daughter of Ishmael (Ishmaelite)

Which lines up perfectly with what we read elsewhere in Scripture:

Genesis 27:46

And Rebekah said to Isaac, I am weary of my life because of the daughters of Heth: if Jacob take a wife of the daughters of Heth, such as these which are of the daughters of the land, what good shall my life do me?

- Esau had three of those ungodly woman to wife and that's exactly what Rebekah was talking about.

Why did Esau decide to later marry some of the daughters of Ishmael?

Genesis 28:6-9

⁶ When Esau saw that Isaac had blessed Jacob, and sent him away to Padanaram, to take him a wife from thence; and that as he blessed him he gave him a charge, saying, Thou shalt not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan;

⁷ And that Jacob obeyed his father and his mother, and was gone to Padanaram;

⁸ And Esau seeing that the daughters of Canaan pleased not Isaac his father;

⁹ Then went Esau unto Ishmael, and took unto the wives which he had Mahalath the daughter of Ishmael Abraham's son, the sister of Nebajoth, to be his wife.

And later on in Genesis 36 we learn that he also took another wife from the daughters of Ishmael.